



Discussion Forum Etiquette

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Conversations are an integral part of your learning for this course. Each week, there will be a discussion forum which you are encouraged to participate in. The discussion forums will give you an opportunity to express and articulate ideas and to ask questions about things you do not understand. In general, be sure to carefully read each others' posts. Respond to each other, and have fun! More specifically:

- **Be polite.** We have learners from all around the world and with different backgrounds. Something that is easy for you may be challenging for someone else. Let's build an encouraging community. Remember to comment on the ideas of an argument, not on the people they come from.
- **Upvote good posts.** This applies to questions and answers. Upvote it by clicking "Upvote" at the bottom of the post so that good posts can be found more easily.
- **Search before asking.** The forum can become hard to use if there are too many threads, and good discussions happen when people participate in the same thread. Before asking a question, search for a post in the forums by typing what you want to search for into the search box at the top of the forum page. The results will show you forum posts that include the word or words you searched for.
- **Notify staff.** If you want to have a staff member look at your post, please write [Staff] at the start of your post.
- **Be accurate.** Include a descriptive title, and provide as much information as possible: Which part of what problem or video? Why do you not understand the question? What have you tried doing?
- **Write clearly.** We know that English might be a second language for many of you, but correct grammar will help others. Avoid ALL CAPS, abbrev of words (abbreviation of words), and excessive punctuation!!!!
- **Talk to each other.** The discussion questions are questions that you should discuss as a class. This means that you need to read what others have written. Think carefully about what others have said, and engage critically and thoughtfully (and -- this is crucial -- *respectfully*) with the content of what others have said. Hostile and/or overly aggressive tones will not be tolerated. It is okay to disagree, it is okay to argue. But you MUST do so in a way that is helpful, civil, and respectful. The course assistants for this course will monitor the forums regularly. We are here to help you learn. We are very much looking forward to engaging with you in the discussion forums.

For more information about using the discussion forums, please refer to the Coursera Help Center, and the following article: [Get help with course content in the discussion forum](https://www.coursera.org/learn/perception/supplement/RGcnC/discussion-forum-etiquette) 

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